



# Matthias Florian Sahli

## Postdoctoral Researcher

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### ● SUMMARY

I am a postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, and was previously a researcher at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations. I received my PhD in Economics from the University of Neuchâtel in 2023. My research focuses on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization, sustainability and the creative industries. The goal of my work is to provide solid empirical evidence that supports current policy discussions. To do this, I invest considerable time and creativity in developing new datasets and conducting rigorous econometric analyses.

### ● ACADEMIC POSITIONS

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 – present | <b>Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)</b> · Business School, Bern, Switzerland<br>Postdoctoral Researcher                                                                                            |
| 2019 – 2024    | <b>World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)</b> · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland<br>PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024) |

### ● EDUCATION

|             |                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019 – 2023 | <b>University of Neuchâtel</b> · Neuchâtel, Switzerland<br>PhD in Economics                                                           |
| 2016 – 2019 | <b>University of Bern</b> · Bern, Switzerland<br>MSc in Economics                                                                     |
| 2012 – 2016 | <b>University of Bern</b> · Bern, Switzerland<br>BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences                                        |
| 2006 – 2011 | <b>Gymnasium Hofwil &amp; Schule für Gestaltung Bern</b> · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland<br>Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts |

### VISITING

|      |                                                                                                    |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020 | <b>Copenhagen Business School (CBS)</b> · Copenhagen, Denmark<br>Visiting student                  |
| 2020 | <b>University of Southern Denmark (SDU)</b> · Odense, Denmark<br>Visiting student                  |
| 2017 | <b>École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)</b> · Lausanne, Switzerland<br>Visiting student |

### ● FURTHER POSITIONS

|             |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2017 – 2019 | <b>Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)</b> · Bern, Switzerland<br>Internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist, Office of the Chief Economist (2018–2019) |
| 2013 – 2019 | <b>Velokurier Bern</b> · Bern, Switzerland<br>Bike messenger; member of the cooperative (passive member since)                                                                |
| 2011 – 2012 | <b>Stiftung RGZ</b> · Zurich, Switzerland<br>Community service, school for people with multiple disabilities                                                                  |

## ● RESEARCH

|                                    |                        |                     |                                  |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>20</b><br>publications & papers | <b>66</b><br>citations | <b>4</b><br>h-index | <b>5</b><br>peer-reviewed venues |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|

Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-08-08.

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**  
M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 10 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**  
M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**  
M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 3 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**  
M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**  
A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 13 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**  
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 19 citations

### UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage**  
**R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS**  
M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records**  
**SUBMITTED TO JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC BEHAVIOR & ORGANIZATION**  
L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**  
**SUBMITTED TO NPJ HERITAGE SCIENCE**  
M. Sahli et al. · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy**  
**SUBMITTED TO STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL**  
A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025

### WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Open by Design: An Empirical Comparison of National Library Digitization Strategies on Wikimedia Commons**  
**IN PREPARATION**  
M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026

### BOOK CHAPTERS, DISSERTATION & OTHER OUTPUT

- **Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights**  
B Lutes, A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics ...](https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics-...), 2025 · 2025
- **Empirical Essays on the Economics of Creative Industries** **PHD DISSERTATION**  
M. Sahli · *University of Neuchâtel* · 2023
- **VoxEU column: How the US film industry mitigates financial risk**  
A Cuntz, A Muscarnera, PC Oguguo, M Sahli · <https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/how-us-film-industry-mitigates-financial-risk>, 2023 · 2023
- **Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects**  
A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and ...](https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and-...), 2023 · 2023
- **The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany** **BOOK CHAPTER**  
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *CEPR Press & Covid Economics 82* · 2022 · 17 citations
- **Pommerehne Prize, President's Prize and Young Researchers Workshop Best Paper Award**  
F Etro, D Noonan · *Journal of Cultural Economics 45 (3), 513-514*, 2021 · 2021

- **VoxEU column: Appropriation artists: Follow-on innovation versus intermediary liability and trade**

A Cuntz, M Sahli · [https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation ...](https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation-...), 2021 · 2021

- **Cleaner and Responsible Consumption**

S Halli, C Kaya · —

- **In this section**

A Cuntz, A Muscarnera, PC Oguguo, M Sahli · —

- **TEACHING**

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 –  | <b>HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève</b><br>Economics of Innovation (guest lectures)                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2025 –  | <b>Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School</b><br>Entrepreneurial Law (Master) · Digitalrecht (Bachelor) · Data Literacy (continuing education);<br>lecturer and module coordination<br>★ <b>Student evaluation 5.25 / 6 (6 = best possible score)</b> |
| 2025    | <b>EPFL, College of Management</b><br>MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master)<br>★ <b>Student evaluation 1.24 / 4 (1 = best possible score)</b>                                                                                                              |
| ongoing | <b>BFH</b><br>Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects                                                                                                                                                                   |

- **SELECTED TALKS**

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|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 11/2026 | DINAcon — Conference for Digital Sustainability, Kongresszentrum Bern · Bern, Switzerland                                             | <b>SCHEDULED</b> |
| 11/2026 | Swiss National Library · Bern, Switzerland                                                                                            | <b>SCHEDULED</b> |
| 10/2026 | DUN — Dachverband der Urheber- und Nachbarrechtsnutzer · Switzerland                                                                  | <b>SCHEDULED</b> |
| 06/2026 | <u>European Academy of Management Annual Conference (EURAM 2026)</u> · Kristiansand, Norway                                           |                  |
| 06/2025 | International Conference on Cultural Economics (ACEI) · Rotterdam, Netherlands (3 papers)                                             |                  |
| 06/2025 | IP-Network BFH — IP and Economics · Bern, Switzerland                                                                                 |                  |
| 04/2025 | BFH sounding board meeting · Bern, Switzerland                                                                                        |                  |
| 06/2024 | DRUID24 · Nice, France                                                                                                                |                  |
| 03/2024 | EPFL STIP Research Retreat · Crans-Montana, Switzerland                                                                               |                  |
| 02/2024 | <u>Cultural Economics Online Seminars — symposium on causal inference in cultural economics</u> · online (video recording on YouTube) |                  |
| 10/2023 | Unlocking value from digital heritage collections — invited panellist (Wikimedia Italy) · Turin, Italy                                |                  |
| 07/2023 | SERCI Annual Congress · Bournemouth, UK                                                                                               |                  |
| 03/2023 | Digital Economy Workshop, University of Lausanne · Lausanne, Switzerland                                                              |                  |
| 11/2022 | WIPO internal research seminar · Geneva, Switzerland                                                                                  |                  |
| 09/2022 | SERCI Annual Congress, University of Colorado Law School · Boulder, USA                                                               |                  |
| 09/2022 | European Policy for Intellectual Property Conference (EPIP), University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK                                  |                  |
| 09/2022 | Tenth European Workshop on Applied Cultural Economics · Turin, Italy (participant)                                                    |                  |
| 07/2022 | Urban Creativity Conference, University of Lisbon · Lisbon, Portugal                                                                  |                  |
| 06/2022 | Munich Summer Institute (MSI) · Munich, Germany                                                                                       |                  |
| 04/2022 | <u>Cultural Economics Online Seminar</u> · online (video recording on YouTube)                                                        |                  |
| 04/2022 | WIPO internal online seminar · online                                                                                                 |                  |
| 09/2021 | EPIP PhD Workshop · Madrid, Spain                                                                                                     |                  |
| 07/2021 | ACEI Young Researchers Workshop, 21st Conference on Cultural Economics · Lille, France                                                |                  |
| 06/2021 | IRENE PhD Meeting, University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland                                                                   |                  |
| 03/2021 | IP & Innovation PhD Virtual Seminar, University of Lausanne · online                                                                  |                  |
| 12/2020 | Research Workshop, Copenhagen Business School · Copenhagen, Denmark                                                                   |                  |
| 11/2020 | PhD Seminar Series, University of Southern Denmark · Odense, Denmark                                                                  |                  |
| 09/2020 | PhD Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (Law and Economics, Prof. S. Bechtold) · Zurich, Switzerland                                           |                  |

06/2020 First Econ Online Seminar, WIPO · Geneva, Switzerland  
10/2018 Reinventing the world — the power of Industry 4.0 · Belgrade, Serbia

## ● OUTREACH, MEDIA COVERAGE & OTHER OUTPUT

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### PODCASTS

2023 [Do Market Players React to Court Decisions Impacting Art?](#) · Art Law Podcast (Spotify)

### COLUMNS

2025 [Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights](#) · VoxEU Column

09/2023 [The effect of copyright on the digitisation and availability of visual artworks](#) · VoxEU / CEPR

### BLOG COVERAGE

10/2023 [Life after Death: The Effects of an Artist's Death on Exhibitions and Auctions](#) · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

04/2023 [Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects](#) · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

### REPORTS & NOTES

2021 [COVID-19 impact on artistic income — WIPO Economic Research Working Paper No. 65](#) · WIPO

2020 [WIPO Creative Economy Note 2020/21](#) · WIPO

## ● ORGANIZED CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

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2025 – 2026 ICT4S 2026 International Conference, Bern University of Applied Sciences  
Organizing Committee

11/2022 An Industry Practitioners Event on Intellectual Property Rights and U.S. Movie Finance, WIPO  
Geneva  
Co-organizer

## ● POLICY WORK

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2018 Value of IP in the New Economy. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/648) · Co-author

2017 Intellectual Property & Innovation: Inclusive Innovation and MSME Trade. WTO TRIPS submission  
(IP/C/W/635) · Co-author

## ● GRANTS & AWARDS

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2026 Swisscom study — “From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World  
Emission Reductions?” (CHF 32,409)

2021 Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural  
Economics, Lille (USD 500)

2020 Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS  
/ Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

## ● ACADEMIC SERVICE

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Peer review Journal of Cultural Economics (2) · European Journal of Law and Economics · Humanities and Social  
Sciences Communications · Socio-Economic Review · Economics of Governance (1)

Memberships Society for Economic Research on Copyright Issues (2022–2024) · European Policy for Intellectual  
Property (2022–2024) · Association for Cultural Economics International (until 2027)

## ● DOCTORAL COURSES

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Workshop and lecture series in law and economics — ETH Zurich and the Universities of Lucerne, St. Gallen and Zurich  
(Prof. E. Ash, Prof. S. Bechtold, Prof. G. Hertig, Prof. S. Lüchinger, Prof. A. Stremitzer), Spring 2021

Obtaining data from the internet: data crawling for research in business and economics — University of Zurich (Prof. C.  
Peukert, Prof. J. Claussen), Spring 2021

## ● RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

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|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Interests | Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization |
| Languages | Swiss German (native) · German · English · French                                                                                                                                      |
| Software  | Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling                                                                                                                                     |

## ● REFERENCES

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**Prof. Dr. Gaétan de Rassenfosse**  
EPFL

**Dr. Carsten Fink**  
Chief Economist, WIPO

**Prof. Dr. Jan Bieser**  
Bern University of Applied Sciences

**Dr. Alexander Cuntz**  
Senior Economist, WIPO

*E-mail addresses available on request.*